Terrain Park ... Of The Future!

A sneak peek at some of the wacky terrain-park features you'll see this winter.

By Jeff Foss

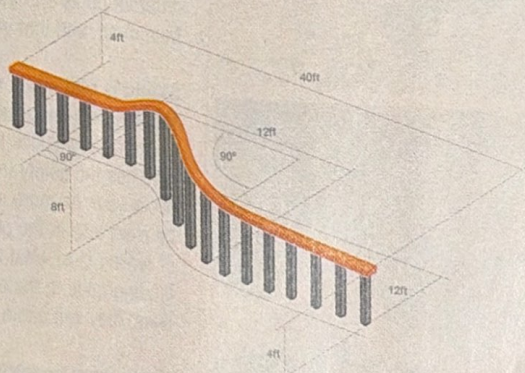
Skier: Peter Olenick
Location: Keystone, Colorado
Photo: Matt Powers/PBP

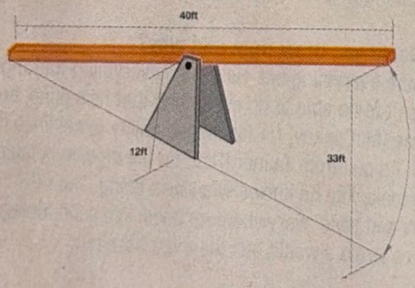
Northstar-at-Tahoe, California

Northstar tapped legendary terrain-park designer Chris Gunnarson to reconceptualize its terrain. He's most excited about a feature tentatively dubbed the "Play Action Jump," a massive tabletop with a large stock rail down the center and dueling hip jumps on either side. This all-inclusive setup allows several park rats to hit the feature simultaneously—sort of like a Juicy Fruit commercial. "It will take a ton of snow to set up," says Gunnarson, "but it will be a super-versatile feature. Plus, you'll be able to go as big or small as you want on the hip jumps, so it caters to all different skill levels."

Copper Mountain, Colorado

The Copper crew is creating an eight-foot-high, 40-foot-long corkscrew rail—an oddity that will resemble an oversized, stretched-out section of a wine-bottle opener. Terrain Park Manager Doug Hagen and the Copper Freeride Team came up with the idea during a midsummer brainstorming session and what started as a rough sketch on notebook paper is fast becoming a reality. "People who know how to seriously bend steel are taking care of the major stuff," says Hagen. "Then we're going to bring it back here, slap legs and skirting on it, and set her up in the park."



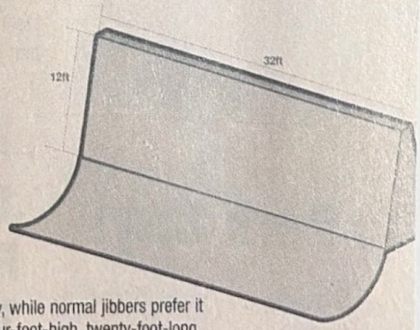


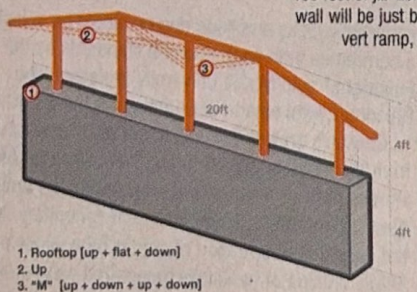
Aspen, Colorado

Aspen's teeter-totter rail is similar to the one used by MSP in *Ski Movie III*: a 40-foot straight rail bisected by a sturdy, twelve-foot-high hinge. As you slide up and past the hinged midpoint, the rail tilts under your weight, seesawing you down toward the snow. Once you're off, a counterweight pulls it back into position for the next rider. "There's so much crazy stuff in terrain parks to huck yourself off," says Aspen Park Manager Greg Boyd. "This project is something fun and different that integrates the playground feel."

June Mountain, California

June Mountain's wallride was already popular, but version 2.0 should really impress. It's practically a drive-in movie screen: twelve feet tall and 32 feet wide. That's almost 400 feet of jib-able surface area! To increase trickability for pros and novices alike, the wall will be just barely slanted to prevent you from flying away from it. "It's a lot like a vert ramp, so it should encourage more skate-inspired tricks," says Rosenwald.





1. Rooftop [up + flat + down]
2. Up
3. "M" [up + down + up + down]

Breckenridge, Colorado

Crazy nocturnal jibbers slide rails at night and barhop during the day, while normal jibbers prefer it the other way around. At Breck you get the best of both worlds: a four-foot-high, twenty-foot-long "bar" will be set up in the park this season. It will provide a place for riders to drink, plus one of three rails (a straight rail, an M-shaped rail, or an up-rail) attached to and elevated above the bar. "It fits in well with the nightlife here," says Park Manager Tim Eastley. "And the three rails are easy to switch around, so there will be a lot of variety."

Oakley's Latest Goggle Cures Blindnes